Willem Johannes Smith

Full Stack Engineer

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SUMMARY

Full Stack Engineer and founder writing software since 2021, shipping and owning production systems end to end — React / Next.js and Go / Node.js on Dockerized CI/CD pipelines — with a low-level C / C++ foundation from 42 Abu Dhabi and a growing focus on agentic AI systems. Experienced in technical leadership, microservices architecture, and DevOps automation.

SKILLS

Languages	TypeScript, JavaScript, Go, C, C++, Python, SQL, HTML, CSS
Frontend	React, Next.js, React Native, Capacitor, Vue.js, Nuxt.js, Tailwind CSS, SASS, GSAP, Astro, SwiftUI
Backend	Node.js, Express, NestJS, Gin, Flask, REST APIs, WebSockets, Socket.IO, MQTT, OAuth 2.0, Supabase, PostgreSQL, MariaDB
DevOps & Cloud	Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions (self-hosted runners), Git, Linux, Nginx, DigitalOcean, Cloudflare, Rolling deployments and rollback
Desktop & Security	PyQt5, Envelope encryption (DEK / KEK), Unit testing, Automated release delivery
AI	Claude Code, Claude Agent SDK, Agentic workflows, Local LLMs (llama.cpp), Prompt engineering
Practices	Microservices, Agile, Code review, Test-driven development, Performance optimization, SEO
Soft Skills	Technical leadership, Mentoring, Ownership, Communication, Pragmatic problem-solving, Adaptability, Cross-team collaboration

EXPERIENCE

Cormonity

Dec 2025 – Present

Founder & Lead Engineer · Abu Dhabi, UAE

- Designed and built a community-native learning platform end-to-end as a solo engineer — **Vue 3 / NestJS / PostgreSQL** with native mobile apps (Capacitor), real-time messaging (MQTT, Socket.IO), and CI/CD to **Kubernetes** behind Cloudflare — now live in production with UAE training institutes onboarding.
- Architected a **verifiable digital-credential system**: tamper-evident SHA-256 issuance records with an append-only audit trail, HMAC-signed access URLs, and server-rendered certificates (including Arabic RTL typesetting) that anyone can verify by QR in seconds without an account.
- Maintained production-grade engineering discipline as a team of one: **1,500+ automated tests** across backend and frontend, versioned course publishing, database-migration workflows, and privacy-by-design data handling (no identity documents stored on-platform).
- Pioneered an **AI-agent development methodology** — plan, adversarial review, and live end-to-end verification for every change — enabling delivery of a multi-product platform (LMS, community, credentials, analytics) at a pace typically requiring a full team.

Suportech Embedded

Apr 2026 – Aug 2026

Embedded Software Developer (Part-time)

- Developed desktop software in **Python** (PyQt5 front end, Flask backend) with automated **CI/CD** release delivery.
- Implemented data security with **envelope encryption (DEK / KEK)** to protect sensitive data at rest.
- Built an application updater with a **CI/CD pipeline** that publishes versioned executables to a registry for automated rollout.
- Authored **unit tests** on GitHub Actions (windows-latest) runners, with changes gated by code review before merging to dev.

Ratchet Capital

Apr 2024 – Apr 2026

Full Stack Developer · Abu Dhabi, UAE (Full-time)

- Shipped through a code-review-gated Git workflow — feature branches reviewed before merging to **dev**, with weekly **dev** → **main** production releases.

PROJECTS AT RATCHET CAPITAL

Megastars.ai v2 — Next.js, Supabase, TypeScript, Cloudflare

- Supported **500+ active influencers** at **99.9% uptime** and 10K+ daily auth requests, delivering full-stack features across the Next.js / Supabase platform.
- Configured multi-provider OAuth 2.0 (Instagram / TikTok / YouTube), built dashboard features, and improved landing-page SEO.

Influenz — Megastars.ai v1 — Tech Lead — Vue.js, Gin (Go), Node.js, PostgreSQL, Docker

- Led a 4-developer team architecting a **4-service Dockerized microservices** platform behind Nginx — Vue / Vite frontend, Gin (Go) REST API, a dedicated Node.js OAuth 2.0 / identity service, and PostgreSQL.
- Standardized environments with separate **dev and prod Docker Compose** stacks driven from a root Makefile, sharing inherited service definitions for DRY config and clean separation of concerns.
- Provisioned **staging and production DigitalOcean droplets** on self-hosted Linux GitHub Actions runners, with a rolling-deploy workflow and automated rollback.

Verif-y — Frontend Developer — React Native, Expo, TypeScript

- Cut document-verification time **~60%** with a cross-platform iOS / Android app — canvas signature capture and skeleton loading.

ioMega Energy — Solo Developer — Eleventy, SASS, Docker, Nginx, GSAP

- Scored **95+ Lighthouse** and cut CSS 60% on a production SEO site with sub-2.1s loads; zero-downtime rolling deploys via GitHub Actions.

Trescudo — Solo Developer — Eleventy, Nunjucks, Docker, Nginx

- Hit **98 performance** with 85% image-size reduction (WebP) and sub-100ms responses on a cybersecurity marketing site.

42 Abu Dhabi — Aug 2022 – Present

Student Tutor & Mentor (Part-time)

- Mentor peers on build systems (Makefiles), memory-management practices, and clean C / C++ at 42 Abu Dhabi.

42 Abu Dhabi — 2021 – 2023

Software Engineering Trainee · Common Core

- Full-time, project-based engineering programme: built and shipped peer-evaluated systems in low-level C / C++, Unix, networking, concurrency, and DevOps.

ft_transcendence — Frontend Lead · Jun 2023 – Nov 2023 — Nuxt.js, WebSockets, NestJS, PostgreSQL, Docker

Built the Nuxt.js dashboard including stats-count components, and the WebSocket chat frontend with direct messages and group messaging.

ft_irc — Team Lead · Mar 2023 – Jun 2023 — C++, Sockets, poll()

Led a 3-engineer team; designed the server architecture with poll()-based message polling and dispatch; verified against real-world IRC clients (irssi).

Inception — Feb 2023 – Mar 2023 — Docker, MariaDB, WordPress, Nginx

Dockerized MariaDB / WordPress / Nginx stack via Docker Compose, built and evaluated inside a virtual machine.

minishell — Co-lead · Aug 2022 – Oct 2022 — C

Co-led a 2-person team; focused on the parser (tokenizing, expansions); contributed to execution and refactored for clean C.

PROJECTS

Jarvis — Jun 2026 – Present — SwiftUI, Node.js, Claude Agent SDK, llama.cpp

Native macOS voice assistant with wake-word detection and on-device speech recognition, orchestrated by a Node.js / TypeScript daemon on the Claude Agent SDK — 42 tok/s on-device within an 18 GB budget, plus an iOS companion app with on-device fallback.

Jellybean PM — Apr 2026 — Astro, GitHub Issues API, TypeScript

GitHub-Issues-powered project-management integration for Astro — drag-and-drop Kanban, sprint planning, milestones, time tracking, a docs browser, and real-time chat with no external database or SaaS.

EDUCATION

42 Abu Dhabi — 2021 – 2023

Software Engineering — Common Core Certification (Nov 2023)

AWARDS

AgentEra AI Hackathon — Certificate of Appreciation, MOEI × 42 Abu Dhabi

LANGUAGES

English Native **Afrikaans** Native **Spanish** Beginner